

Q. At what point does TDF get associated with a project done by an external entity?

A. TDF comes into the picture when contributions become a part of the open source project. While there may be activities external to TDF, we are comfortable with them as long as they do not fall under the brand of LibreOffice or TDF. Contributors have the freedom of open source to pursue their own projects independently. TDF's role becomes prominent while orchestrating specific aspects, such as quality assurance, when contributions are integrated into the core of LibreOffice or when an event is organised under the banner of LibreOffice or TDF. At these junctures, it's essential for the Foundation to exercise a level of control over what is done and the quality of the work produced.

Q. What challenges do organisations like TDF face, and how do you resolve them?

A. The primary challenge for a foundation is the potential loss of contributions, which are its lifeblood. Operating without a traditional business model and not developing software internally, all development comes from external contributors. Losing ecosystem partners or volunteers significantly diminishes the foundation's relevance. TDF has staff members who need compensation, requiring a steady flow of donations. To counter these challenges, TDF actively seeks donations, particularly from professional software users. The Foundation also focuses on acquiring new members and growing the community for sustainability. TDF closely monitors operational health, including contributions, community involvement, and donations. Monitoring

is vital because if these sources cease, the Foundation would be more or less dead.

Q. Did you achieve what you came to Open Source India for? How was your experience here?

A. My goal at Open Source India was to expand the LibreOffice community in India. I'm pleased to find active contributors here. The event has seen daily active participation from many people, which is commendable. My experience has been perfect, the location excellent, and attending worthwhile. The response to my session was encouraging, with many showing interest, so I believe I have achieved my goal. I'm expecting a lot of follow-up engagement. So, yes, I believe my visit has been successful and productive. **END** 🐧

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